



Figure 4: Easy Install



Figure 5: The DreamLinux Control Panel

install icons were still there. I cleaned my desktop removing the install icons and installed ATI proprietary drivers... Dreamlinux Control Panel lists an install option for NVIDIA drivers, but when you click on it, you're only guided on how to install it. To install drivers, simply press CTRL+ALT+F1 and type `nvidia-install` or `ati-install` to install the respective proprietary drivers.

I noted that the wizard was about to install older drivers. I closed the install set-up and installed `fglrx` from the latest ATI Catalyst 9.3. After rebooting, I was able to get the full resolution for my monitor. But I wasn't able to get hold of Compiz' composite effects. With some searching and help from developers, I was able to use Compiz. To enable it in the ATI/NVIDIA card, in case it doesn't work,



Figure 6: Big Buck Bunny in XBMC

open the terminal and take the following steps.

```
sudo gedit /etc/X11/xorg.conf
```

Insert the line in the 'Extensions' section, if it is not present there:

```
Section "Extensions"
```

```
Option "Composite" "Enable"
```

```
EndSection
```

Dreamlinux comes only with a handful of Compiz plug-ins, but you can install restricted and additional plug-ins—it's Debian, so you have the apt-get magic. You can then enable it from CCSM. Though in my case, whenever I select additionally installed plug-ins, it gets deselected automatically! Pretty weird, right?

The next thing was to set up my printer. I plugged it in and opened the DL Control Panel. Since there was a Printer Wizard, I thought of setting it up, but was unable to. Then I installed `hp-lip`, `sane`, `sane-utils` packages, and headed to configure it again. It was detected and set up correctly. I was able to print documents, but somehow Xsane didn't recognise my printer!

Lots of home-made goodies!

On the applications front, you might be a little upset at first, but once you use all that's available you will be pleased—it still has all the necessary tools for daily work. Some of the major numbers that we all like to see are:

- Linux Kernel 2.6.28.5
- Xorg 1.3 (it's too old I know; 1.6 is out now!)
- Alsa 1.0.16 (another old release)
- Xfce 4.4.2
- GIMP 2.6.0, Inkscape 0.46
- OpenOffice.org 2.4.1 (old again!)
- Firefox 3.0.6

XFCE 4.6 was not included, because it was released only a day before Dreamlinux 3.5 came out! Refer to Table 1 for a list of applications this distro comes with, by default.

DL ships a lot of multimedia utilities—Avidemux for video editing, EasyTAG for ID3 tag editing, Totem for video and